

DEEP DIVE — MASTER PLAN · Financing, Production & Distribution

Producer's operating plan · compiled 12 July 2026 · companion to the Film Bible + DEEP_DIVE.md

*Research verified 12 Jul 2026 (three research passes: funding / distribution / fact-check).
Unverified items are marked.*

o · WHERE WE STAND (asset inventory)

Shot: Krk (done) (~16 interviews, dives, festival) · Sicily (done) (1–6 Jul) — with **Etna erupting inside the shoot window** (RED aviation alert 5 Jul, Catania airport closed — documented news event, archive licensable to augment our footage) and **Petar's blackout on the monofin attempt** (zero press footprint › we likely own the only footage of it). **Spent:** ~€10k, 100% Tomo. No equity sold. Full access + trust of the four. That's the leverage — protect it. **The story now:** Petar holds 3 of 4 absolute depth records (FIM 137m · CWTB 128m › *missing from the bible, add it* · CNF 103m). The missing one is CWT monofin — the Sicily miss. The film gained its opening (Etna), its wound (the blackout), and its ending (Vegas induction) this month.

Decisions locked 12 Jul (Tomo):

1. **Cyprus vs USA** › depends on the four; plan BOTH variants until they confirm (ask at Lastovo).
 2. **Company** › not started; found the d.o.o. + Očevidnik NOW.
 3. **Bridge budget** › €10–25k of Tomo's capital for Lastovo + USA; sponsors close the rest.
 4. **Releases** › nothing signed; draft HR/EN this week, sign at Lastovo.
-

1 · THE STRATEGY IN ONE PARAGRAPH

Finish shooting the year (Lastovo › USA › Cyprus-variant › Rijeka lab › coda) on lean self+sponsor money **without selling any equity**, while building the institutional engine in parallel: d.o.o. + Očevidnik now, **IDFA Forum entry by 25 July**, **HAVC production rok 10 September**, foreign co-producer (Italy and/or Hungary) locked by winter, Eurimages once the co-pro exists, 25%+5% rebate on the Croatian spend + post. Sales agent courted from the sizzle onward (MetFilm Sales first). Picture lock spring–summer 2027. World premiere **Telluride/TIFF Sept 2027** (Plan A) or Tribeca Jun 2027 (Plan B), European premiere IDFA 2027, streamer deal closed by an agent off the premiere — realistic band \$300k–\$1.5M, outliers higher with awards heat. Netflix takes no cold pitches (verified) — the agent/EP IS the door.

2 · THE CLOCK — dated actions

NOW › 25 July (the two-week sprint)

Deadline	Action	Notes
ASAP	Cut the sizzle (3–5 min: Etna opening › Krk bonds › Sicily attempt/blackout-tease › Vegas tease)	The asset every other line depends on. Decide who edits TODAY.
ASAP	Found the d.o.o. (with Luka per bible) + court register, NKD 59.11	e-osnivanje takes days; €2,500 min capital (or j.d.o.o. €1 to start fast — check HAVC acceptability)
ASAP +15d lead	Očevidnik producenata application (ocevidnici.havc.hr, ocevidnici@havc.hr)	15-day lead; gate for ALL HAVC money
25 Jul 23:59 CEST	IDFA Forum entry (€30; professionals.idfa.nl)	Forum = 15–18 Nov, Amsterdam. For projects IN PRODUCTION — exactly us. ARTE/ZDF/YLE/BBC + sales agents in one room. Needs: logline, synopsis, promo link, budget + finance plan, producer info. <i>The bible's "15 Aug" is stale — festival film entry closed 9 Jul; Forum closes 25 Jul.</i>
Before Lastovo (~20 Jul)	Releases drafted (HR/EN participant release + life-story rights; lawyer pass)	Sign during camp weeks. 2023 chapter: limited approval right over that chapter only — NOT general final cut (streamer-compatible).
Before Lastovo	Lastovo shoot bible (Sicily-bible format)	Camps confirmed: 20–26 Jul · 26 Jul–2 Aug · 2–9 Aug, Zaklopatica, Adriatic Freediving (Vito's outfit, Molchanovs curriculum)
This week	Email ISHOF / Dr. Goldman's office	Confirm class list (Kasparov!), request filming permission 26 Sept ceremony, Palms Grand Ballroom. No public filming policy exists — ask, don't assume. Route via Toni/Select PR if useful.

August (Lastovo weeks — shoot + apply)

- **Shoot Lastovo** (the deep 2023 sit · the sport laid bare · Borna's arc if still in · sign releases · ask the four the Cyprus question).
- **Prepare HAVC production application** for the **10 Sept rok** (dugometražni dokumentarni; avg award ~€52k/film, 6 of 16 funded last round). Track record is scored › **attach an established Croatian co-producer/производитель** to the application if at all possible.
- Sponsor wave 1 with the sizzle: **Mares** (warm via Sanda — confirmed her sponsor) › **Molchanovs** (Zsófia is their athlete; Lastovo teaches their curriculum — the camp is literally their product) › **Garmin** (no flagship freediving story exists — we're it; Descent G2 has apnea modes) › Croatian pride tier (HTZ, Jamnica/Jana, HT, Rimac). Ask = cash for USA block + gear; give = credits, content spinoffs, event presence. **Never final cut.**

- USA production prep: ESTA/visas, RV quote (Vegas>SF per app bible), kit carnet, US production insurance, venue/event permissions, Kasparov team contact for release.

September–October

- **10 Sept:** HAVC production application IN (+ međunarodna suradnja same day for IDFA travel money if eligible).
- **USA tour** (3 weeks around **26 Sept, Palms Hotel Vegas** — Olympia weekend 24–27 Sept). Cover: induction (vindication beat — possible film opening per "Surface to the ending, then sink"), Kasparov moment if released, RV road trip, side events, maybe the coda dive.
- **Cyprus variant** if the four say yes: AIDA Depth Worlds, **Limassol 27 Sept–10 Oct** — collision with Vegas (Vito can't do both). Variant A: skip, world-stage beat = Lastovo comp. Variant B: split team (second shooter with Petar/Zsófia). Variant C: USA compressed › Limassol finale (~8–10 Oct).
- **CPH:FORUM submission opens Sept, closes early Nov** — our fallback/second market if IDFA Forum says no.

November–December

- **IDFA (12–22 Nov) + Forum (15–18 Nov)** — Amsterdam. Even if not selected: attend on industry pass (HAVC travel support), meet sales agents with sizzle v2 (now incl. Vegas). Priority order: **MetFilm Sales** (made+sold *Last Breath* — closest precedent), **Dogwoof**, **Autlook**; US route: Submarine / Cinetic. They now board at rough-cut with money — that's normal.
- **HRT** doc editorial meeting (their 2027 co-production call lands ~Dec–Feb; LOI now, offer when it opens).
- **WEMW Trieste deadline ~Oct · East Doc Platform ~Nov** · lock the **foreign minority co-producer**: Italy first (Sicily spend already exists; WEMW is their turf; Sanda's Trieste link), Hungary parallel (Zsófia › NFI minority scheme). This unlocks **Eurimages** (>=2 countries, docs >=70', up to 25% of budget / €500k — the single biggest cheque available).
- Rijeka/Zagreb lab shoot + **Filming-in-Croatia rebate application >=8 days before** that block (25%+5%; docs min qualifying spend €60k — clear it by bundling remaining Croatian shoots + the whole edit/post done in Croatia. Krk/Lastovo spend before the company existed is likely lost to the rebate — cost of starting late, accept and move).

2027

- **Jan–Mar:** edit (assembly › rough). Eurimages deadline #1 (early Jan, verify) with co-producer. ZagrebDox Pro (~Feb, free, home turf) · East Doc Platform (Mar) · **CPH:FORUM (14–18 Mar)**.
- **Spring:** rough cut › sales agent formally attached › **Cannes Docs market screenings (May)** — warms buyers without burning premiere.
- **Sept 2027: WORLD PREMIERE — Telluride or TIFF Docs** (TIFF deadline ~May 2027). Fallbacks: Tribeca Jun 2027 (deadline ~Dec 2026–Jan 2027, rough cut OK), Hot Docs (Ontario-premiere-only rule = flexible). **European premiere: IDFA 2027** (entry ~Jul 2027). Then DOC NYC (the *14 Peaks* springboard).
- **Post-premiere:** streamer deal (agent-led). If no global buy by late 2027 › split rights: Nat Geo/HBO Max territories + ARTE La Lucarne/ZDF/YLE + Croatian event-theatrical (four national heroes = real box office at home) + **Banff/Kendal/Ocean world tours** (revenue + the *Alpinist* long-tail engine) + windowed YouTube endgame (Patagonia/Yes Theory model — the freediving

community is huge online).

- Sundance 2027: **skip** (lock too late + total premiere purity required). Sundance 2028 only if we deliberately hold the film — we won't.

3 • MONEY MAP (three lanes, don't confuse them — per bible §12)

Lane 1 — Sponsors/brands (fast, no equity): funds the remaining shoots. Tiers per bible + new intel: Mares (WARM), Molchanovs (natural fit), Garmin (open lane, no freediver flagship), Suunto/Shearwater, Croatian pride (HTZ, Jamnica, HT, Rimac, banks), wild metaphor tier (Whoop/Oura — the 20bpm heart; watch brands — depth+time). Sponsor gets: credits, content series, event presence, athlete association. Sponsor never gets: final cut, the 2023 chapter. **Lane 2 — Institutional (slow, structural):** HAVC production (10 Sept; ~€50k class) › HRT (LOI › 2027 call) › foreign co-producer(s) (IT/HU) › their national funds + **Eurimages** (<=€500k) › Creative Europe (parked — new company ineligible until Deep Dive is delivered; then Mini-Slate 2028) › rebate 25%+5% on Croatian spend incl. post › city/county culture calls autumn (Rijeka/PGŽ/Zagreb, €3–10k tier, local legitimacy). **Lane 3 — Market (the endgame):** sales agent MG/presales after rough cut · streamer acquisition post-premiere (\$300k–\$1.5M realistic band) · Red Bull Studios as possible co-financier (price = control; handle carefully) · Croatian theatrical + tours + windowed digital. **Dead:** Al Jazeera Balkans ceased operations 2025 — remove from all thinking.

Bridge budget (Tomo's €10–25k, decision-gated):

- Lastovo ~ €8–12k (Tomo-led; 1 shooter on peak days ~10 paid days €2.5k; lodging/boat/travel; NP permits).
- USA ~ €10–14k lean (2 people: flights ~€1.6k, RV 3wk ~€3.5k, fuel/camps ~€1.5k, insurance ~€1k, per diems, Vegas nights).
- Cyprus variant B adds ~€3–5k (one shooter + flights) — only if the four confirm competing.
- Gate: if a sponsor closes >=€10k before 1 Sept, upgrade USA crew; if nothing closes, USA runs at floor spec.

4 • RIGHTS & LEGAL (streamer-delivery reality — start now)

1. **Participant releases + life-story rights** — the four + supporting cast + family. 2023 chapter: contractually honor the working-paper promises as a **limited approval right over the 2023 chapter only** (veto on that chapter's cut), never general final cut — otherwise no streamer E&O passes. Lawyer required.
2. **Krk tournament footage** — "we receive all footage" › get it IN WRITING (license from organizer).
3. **Blue World / Sicily UW footage** — license paper.
4. **The 2023 search video** (secretly filmed, posted online) — using it = defamation/privacy/copyright review. Truth defense is strong (negative WADA tests, ITA no-violation, the Škerbić 2025 paper) but this is exactly what **E&O insurance + media lawyer** exist for. Budget it.

5. **Language discipline:** always "cleared by negative WADA-lab tests; punished via a three-page Code of Ethics; no doping violation" — never "doping conviction." Legally material, verified.
 6. **ISHOF ceremony** — venue (Palms) + ISHOF media permission; **Kasparov appearance release** if he features beyond incidental (his team must sign; treat him as bonus, never spine).
 7. Guinness/AIDA/CMAS archive licensing list · music · drone rules (EU + FAA Part 107 for USA) · US filming status for crew (ESTA/B-1 gray zone — get advice before booking).
 8. **Deal memos** for all crew (work-for-hire, rights to the production company once it exists — re-paper Krk/Sicily crew work onto the new d.o.o.).
-

5 • TEAM GAPS (honest)

- **Croatian co-producer with HAVC track record** — the single highest-value attach before 10 Sept. Neutralizes track-record scoring, carries finance/admin so Tomo directs. **Shortlist done > COPRODUCER-SHORTLIST.md: Restart first call (Fiume o morte! = Rijeka + Italy + Eurimages playbook), then Wolfgang & Dolly, Hulahop.** Key: HAVC Pravilnik čl. 7 scores the producer's last 3 films > partner must sign the prijavnica as co-producer, not a support letter.
- **Editor with feature-doc credits** — financiers fund editors almost as much as directors. Attach by rough-cut phase at latest.
- **International EP** — the *Deepest Breath* lesson: the Netflix deal rode on Battsek/A24 package. One respected adventure-doc EP name changes everything. Ask sales agents' advice at IDFA — they love making these matches.
- Media lawyer (releases, E&O) · post house (Zagreb — rebate-eligible spend) · festival PR (2027, not now).
- Athletes' PR = Toni/Select PR — keep separated from the film's PR (bible principle, still correct).

6 • RISK REGISTER

1. **Blackout footage consent** — Petar must see and approve how the blackout is used before it's in any sizzle shown outside the room. It's also ammunition for post-2023 trolls — context is everything. Handle at Lastovo, gently, per the working-paper promises.
2. **No releases yet** — everything is goodwill until Lastovo signing. Top priority.
3. **Deadline stack 25 Jul / 10 Sept** — both fail if the sizzle and company registration slip this week.
4. **Kasparov** — same-class induction is Medium-High confidence (no primary ISHOF page opened); verify with ISHOF before building scenes on it.
5. **Cyprus collision** — resolved only by the four (Lastovo conversation).
6. **Competitor journalist manuscript** — outpace with footage-in-hand + signed exclusivity (the releases).
7. **Tomo burnout / solo-everything** — director+producer+DP+editor+investor+app-dev is not a 2027 plan. The autumn co-producer attach is the fix; calendar it like a deadline.
8. **Market reality** — doc acquisitions are slow and selective (zero in-festival Sundance 2026 buys). The plan survives a no-streamer outcome via split rights + tours + home theatrical. Build Plan A distribution muscles anyway.

7 • APP (Deep Dive V1.1) — production OS tasks

- Deploy to Vercel (shared URL for crew/the four) — already in app backlog.
- Enter into Schedule: Lastovo camps (20 Jul–9 Aug), HAVC roks (10 Sept), IDFA Forum (25 Jul deadline; 15–18 Nov event), ISHOF (26 Sept), AIDA Worlds (27 Sept–10 Oct), CPH:FORUM (early Nov deadline).
- Data corrections: add Petar CWTB 128m; correct IDFA date everywhere; mark Al Jazeera Balkans dead in any sponsor/buyer lists.
- Contracts view: track release signatures per person at Lastovo.

8 • OPEN QUESTIONS (for Tomo, non-blocking)

1. Who cuts the sizzle — Tomo, Luka, or an outside editor? Is Sicily footage ingested/backed up ×2 and logged?
2. The blackout conversation with Petar — when/how do you want to have it? (Before the sizzle goes anywhere.)
3. d.o.o. details for founding: name, ownership split with Luka, who administers?
4. Any existing relationship to Croatian doc producers for the co-producer attach — or should I build the shortlist?
5. Kasparov contact route — via ISHOF office, or does Vito's PR have a channel?
6. Freediving game + this film: park the game until post-Lastovo (hero-guardrail), or brief it as transmedia in the Forum application?

9 • USA LEG — SERVICES CHECKLIST (no co-production; keep equity clean)

US money enters ONLY as: sponsorship / license-presale / service deal / grant. Never core copro equity while Eurimages is live (non-European share cap ~30%, "European work" status must survive — verify clause when structuring).

- ☐ Fixer/line producer day-rates: Vegas ceremony day + SF permit days
- ☐ US production insurance + COIs (Palms WILL require certificate before cameras enter; casino floors = casino approval, no exceptions)
- ☐ Permits: LVCVA (Vegas public areas), casino property approvals, SF Film Commission
- ☐ Visa/gear advice: ESTA vs B-1 for foreign crew + kit through customs — 1hr with advisor BEFORE booking flights
- ☐ RV barter pitch (vehicle for credit + content) — Cruise America / El Monte class; plus Garmin US / GoPro / Insta360 for the road-trip content block
- ☐ ISHOF permission (in motion) + Kasparov team release route
- ☐ US doc grants research › see US-FUNDS report (agent running 12 Jul)

Artifacts produced: IDFA-FORUM-ENTRY-DRAFT.md · RELEASES-DRAFT.md · COPRODUCER-SHORTLIST.md. Next on request: Lastovo shoot bible · Vanja/Restart outreach email (HR) · ISHOF email (EN) · sponsor one-pager · d.o.o./Očevnik founding checklist · HAVC

application skeleton.